

12(a)(i)	energy required to separate nucleons (of nucleus)	M1
	to infinity	A1
12(a)(ii)	a (single) large nucleus <u>divides</u> to form (smaller) nuclei	B1
	any one point from: - initiated by neutron bombardment - resulting nuclei are of similar size - binding energy per nucleon increases - total binding energy increases - neutrons released - combined mass of smaller nuclei is less than mass of large nucleus	B1
12(b)	binding energy per nucleon is a maximum at around $A = 56$	B1
	products of splitting a ^{56}Fe nucleus must have a lower total binding energy	B1
	(reaction would require) a net input of energy	B1